

LEFI SHAN

TECHNICAL GAME DESIGN • GAMEPLAY SYSTEMS • TECHNICAL ANIMATION

Los Angeles, CA | +1 626 693-4003 | leficious@gmail.com | leficious.com | LinkedIn

PROFILE

Technical game designer with five years of experience across commercial game engines and 2D/3D production tools. Builds combat, AI, progression, interface, and technical-animation systems in Unreal Engine, with a focus on clear player feedback, reusable architecture, and cohesion between formal and dramatic elements. Comfortable bridging design, art, animation, and engineering.

TECHNICAL DESIGN EXPERIENCE

Technical Game Designer - Grid-Based Tactical RPG Template Jan-Mar 2026

Gnomon School of Visual Effects • Unreal Engine

- Implemented A* and Dijkstra pathfinding for a snappable tactical grid and created a UMG grid generator for editing, debugging, and visualizing traversal data.
- Authored reusable animation Blueprint templates for classes, units, and equipment, and organized item, weapon, and unit attributes into shared data structures.

Technical Game Designer - Fallen Valkyrie Jan-Jun 2025

Gnomon School of Visual Effects • Soulslike boss-level vertical slice

- Designed and implemented responsive combat with dodges, weapon switching, resource systems, hit reactions, and animation-notify-driven attack windows.
- Architected a multi-phase boss using StateTree and connected targeting, Enhanced Input, camera transitions, UI feedback, cinematics, and level progression into a cohesive encounter.

Technical Game Designer - Starshore Jun-Dec 2024

Gnomon School of Visual Effects • Solo 15-week open-world prototype

- Built an interconnected playable loop spanning movement, abilities, stats, targeting, inventory, vendors, pickups, animated enemies, and interface systems.
- Implemented player and enemy abilities with the Gameplay Ability System, Behavior Tree enemies, and data-driven inventory and shop interfaces with reusable entries and filters.

TOOLS & TECHNICAL ART

Stylize Normals Toolkit 2026

Maya • Python • Maya API • UX and workflow design

- Developed and documented a production-safe creator tool for transferring, generating, previewing, inspecting, repairing, and comparing custom vertex normals across stylized assets.

MEL-Driven Clockwork Platform 2025

Maya • MEL • Rigging • Procedural animation

- Scripted a complete mechanical rig and animation in MEL, coordinating interdependent clockwork components through reusable procedural controls.

EDUCATION

University of Southern California - School of Cinematic Arts Expected Jun 2028

M.S., Game Design and Development • Los Angeles, CA

Gnomon School of Visual Effects Jun 2025

B.F.A., Digital Production - Games • Los Angeles, CA

TOOLS & SKILLS

Gameplay	Unreal Engine, Blueprint, Gameplay Ability System, StateTree, Behavior Trees, Enhanced Input, UMG
Animation	Animation Blueprints, state machines, Control Rig, IK/FK workflows, animation notifies, realtime cinematics
Programming	Python, Maya API, MEL, C++, C#, Unity, Git, Perforce, data-driven systems
Art pipeline	Maya, Substance 3D Painter/Designer, Photoshop, ZBrush, SpeedTree, Gaea
Languages	English (native), Mandarin Chinese (fluent)